INCH-POUND
MIL-PRF-32002A
5 September 1997
SUPERSEDING
MIL-PRF-32002(AT)
5 May 1997

PERFORMANCE SPECIFICATION

COVER MATERIAL, VEHICLE, COATED TACTICAL AND COMBAT, HEAVY-DUTY, WATERPROOF

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for heavy-duty, waterproof, coated tactical and combat vehicle cover material (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirement documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Tank-automotive and Armaments Command, ATTN: AMSTA-TR-E/BLUE, Warren, MI 48397-5000 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSG 25GP

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2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

MIL-C-46168 - Coating, Aliphatic Polyurethane, Chemical Agent Resistant.

STANDARDS

FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of the above specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Document Order Desk, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION (DoT)

49 CFR, Section 571.302 - Code of Federal Regulations (CFR).

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

40 CFR, Part 798 - Code of Federal Regulations.

(Copies of the Code of Federal Regulations are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DoDISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

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AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF TEXTILE CHEMISTS AND COLORISTS (AATCC)

AATCC Evaluation Procedure 1 - Gray Scale for Color Change.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists, 1 Davis Drive, PO Box 12215, Research Triangle Park, NC 27709-2215.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM D471	- Standard Test Method for Rubber Property - Effect of Liquids (DoD Adopted).
ASTM D523	- Standard Test Method for Specular Gloss (DoD Adopted).
ASTM D751	- Standard Test Methods for Coated Fabrics (DoD Adopted).
ASTM D2136	- Standard Test Method for Coated Fabrics - Low-Temperature Bend Test (DoD Adopted).
ASTM D3389	- Standard Test Method for Coated Fabrics Abrasion Resistance (Rotary Platform, Double-Head Abrader) (DoD Adopted).
ASTM D3393	- Standard Specification for Coated Fabrics - Waterproofness.
ASTM D5034	- Standard Test Method for Breaking Strength and Elongation of Textile Fabrics (Grab Test) (DoD Adopted).
ASTM D5035	- Standard Test Method for Breaking Force and Elongation of Textile Fabrics (Strip Method) (DoD Adopted).
ASTM G21	- Standard Practice for Determining Resistance of Synthetic Polymeric Materials to Fungi (DoD Adopted).
ASTM G26	- Standard Practice for Operating Light-Exposure Apparatus (Xenon-Arc Type) with and without Water for Exposure of Nonmetallic Materials (DoD Adopted).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.)

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SOCIETY OF AUTOMOTIVE ENGINEERS, INC. (SAE)

SAE J883	- Test Method for Determining Dimensional Stability of Automotive Textile Materials.
SAE J1351	- Hot Odor Test for Insulation Materials.
SAE J1966	- Lubricating Oil, Aircraft Piston Engine (Nondispersant Mineral Oil) (DoD Adopted).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Society of Automotive Engineers, Inc., 400 Commonwealth Drive, Warrendale, PA 15096-0001.)

TAPPI

TAPPI T451 CM	- Flexural Properties of Paper (Clark Stiffness).

(Application for copies should be addressed to TAPPI, 15 Technology Parkway S, Norcross, GA 30092.)

2.4 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with 4.2.

3.2 Material requirements. The contractor shall choose to meet either Option A or Option B:

Option A: The base cloth shall be plain woven with high-tenacity polyester, have a minimum of 25 yarns per inch in both the fill and warp direction, and be coated with poly (vinyl chloride) (PVC) or polyurethane. The coated cloth shall have a minimum weight of 19 ounces per square yard (oz/yd^2) and a maximum weight of 22 oz/yd^2, and shall conform to the performance requirements in 3.3 through 3.21. The color of the coated vehicle cloth shall be as specified in the contract (see 6.2).

Option B: The base cloth shall have a minimum strength of 250 pounds (lb.) in both the warp and the fill direction, and be coated with poly (vinyl chloride) (PVC) or polyurethane. The coated cloth shall have a minimum weight of 19 oz/yd^2 and a

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maximum weight of 22 oz/yd^2, and shall conform to the performance requirements in 3.3 through 3.21. The color of the coated vehicle cloth shall be as specified in the contract (see 4.5.2 and 6.2).

3.3 Resistance to low/high temperatures. Coated vehicle cover material shall provide acceptable uninterrupted performance, without deterioration, under any extreme condition of inclement weather and in ambient air temperatures from -50 degrees Fahrenheit (°F) to +125°F. The performance of the material shall not deteriorate at temperature extremes for exposure duration of up to six months. Additionally, the coated material shall be capable of being stored without affecting any of the requirements in 3.2 through 3.21 for two years at a time at temperatures that may cycle daily to 140°F (see 4.5.1, 4.5.3, and 4.5.4).

3.4 Mildew resistance. Coated vehicle cover material shall exhibit a “no growth” rating (“0” rating) (see 4.5.5).

3.5 Odor. Coated vehicle cover material odor rating shall not exceed a rating number of 2 and no toxic fumes shall be present when subjected to 140°F for six hours minimum under wet and dry conditions (see 4.5.6).

3.6 Flame resistance. Coated vehicle cover material shall not permit flame progression of more than 4.0 inches per minute (see 4.5.7).

3.7 Infrared reflectance. Coated vehicle cover material shall meet the required spectral reflectance properties as specified in MIL-C-46168 for both sides (Class A) of the cover material or one side only (Class B) (see 6.2). The cover material shall not be painted with CARC paint (see 4.5.1).

3.8 Glossiness. There shall be low gloss on both sides (Class A) of the material or one side only (Class B) (see 6.2). The gloss reading at 60 degrees shall be not greater than 1 unit and, at 85 degrees, shall be not greater than 3.5 units (see 4.5.8). Class B material shall have low gloss on the same side as infrared reflectance (see 3.7).

3.9 Dimensional stability. The coated fabric shall show no tendency to curl at the edges or wrinkle when lying flat. Coated vehicle cover material shall have a maximum shrinkage/growth of 0.4 percent in both the warp and fill directions (see 4.5.9).

3.10 Breaking force. Coated vehicle cover material shall have a minimum break force of 325 lb. in the warp direction and 250 lb. in the fill direction. The percent elongation at break shall be within a range of 15 to 40 percent in the warp direction and a range of 25 to 50 percent in the fill direction (see 4.5.10).

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3.11 Breaking force after accelerated weathering. The coated vehicle cover material shall have a minimum break force of 275 lb. in the warp direction and 180 lb. in the fill direction after exposure to accelerated weathering (see 4.5.11).

3.12 Tearing strength. Coated vehicle cover material shall have a minimum tear strength of 50 lb. in both the warp and fill directions (see 4.5.12).

3.13 Waterproofness. Coated vehicle cover material shall exhibit no leakage when subjected to a static pressure head of 50 centimeters for 1 hour at 140°F. The material shall meet this requirement in both the body of the fabric as well as the seam areas (see 4.5.13).

3.14 Coating adhesion. Both sides of the coated vehicle cover material shall have a minimum coating adhesion of 20 lb. per 2 inch width in the warp direction (see 4.5.14).

3.15 Stiffness. Coated vehicle cover material shall have maximum stiffness in the warp direction of 16.5 centimeters and 22.0 centimeters deflection at 70°F and 10°F, respectively (see 4.5.15).

3.16 Blocking resistance at elevated temperature. Coated vehicle cover material shall have a blocking rating of no greater than 2 after 1 hour of exposure at 180°F $\pm$ 2°F (see 4.5.16).

3.17 Resistance to accelerated aging. Coated vehicle cover material shall not experience color change, nor increased softness, stiffness, tackiness, or brittleness when exposed to accelerated aging (see 4.5.17).

3.18 Oil resistance. Lubricating oil conforming to SAE Viscosity Grade 50 of SAE J1966 shall not leak through, seep through, or permeate the coated vehicle cover material (see 4.5.18).

3.19 Resistance to aromatic hydrocarbon fluids. Coated vehicle cover material shall not crack or flake when creased sharply on itself in both the warp and fill directions when immersed in Reference Fuel D (see 4.5.19).

3.20 Toxicity. Coated vehicle cover material shall show no toxicity (see 4.5.20).

3.21 Abrasion resistance. The coated fabric shall meet the requirements as specified in ASTM D3389 using CS-17 abrasive wheels and 1000 gram weights. Samples shall show a minimum value of 350 cycles on the face and 50 cycles on the back (see 4.5.21).

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4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.2).
b. Conformance inspection (see 4.3).

4.2 First article inspection. A sample selected in accordance with 4.4 shall be subjected to the first article tests specified in table I and the examinations specified in 4.5.1. First article inspection samples, properly marked with identifying information, shall be representative of the unit to be furnished to the Government. All subsequent equipment delivered to the Government shall conform to these samples in all of their pertinent physical and performance attributes.

4.3 Conformance inspection. A sample selected in accordance with 4.4 shall be subjected to the conformance tests specified in table I and the examinations specified in 4.5.1.

4.4 Sampling. Samples from an inspection lot shall be selected in accordance with the sampling plan as specified in the contract (see 6.2). Noncompliance with any specified requirement shall be cause for rejection.

4.5 Method of inspection.

4.5.1 Materials. Conformance to 3.3 and 3.7 shall be determined by inspection of contractor records providing proof or certification that materials conform to requirements. Applicable records shall include drawings, specifications, design data, receiving inspection records, processing and quality control standards, certifications, industry standards, test reports, and rating data.

4.5.2 Material requirements. To determine conformance to 3.2, the base cloth shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D5034.

4.5.3 Low temperature bend test. To determine conformance to 3.3, coated vehicle cover material shall rate a “pass“ when tested in accordance with ASTM D2136 at -50°F $\pm$ 5°F for a minimum of 6 hours.

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Table I. Classification of inspections.

Title	Requirements	Inspections	First article Inspection	Conformance Inspection
Material requirements	3.2	4.5.2	X	X
Resistance to low/high temperatures	3.3	4.5.3	X	X
		4.5.4	X	X
Mildew resistance	3.4	4.5.5	X	X
Odor	3.5	4.5.6	X	X
Flame resistance	3.6	4.5.7	X	X
Glossiness	3.8	4.5.8	X	X
Dimensional stability	3.9	4.5.9	X	X
Breaking force	3.10	4.5.10	X	X
Breaking force after accelerated weathering	3.11	4.5.11	X	X
Tearing strength	3.12	4.5.12	X	X
Waterproofness	3.13	4.5.13	X	X
Coating adhesion	3.14	4.5.14	X	X
Stiffness	3.15	4.5.15	X	X
Blocking resistance at elevated temperature	3.16	4.5.16	X	X
Resistance to accelerated aging	3.17	4.5.17	X	X
Oil resistance	3.18	4.5.18	X	X
Resistance to aromatic hydrocarbon fluids	3.19	4.5.19	X	X
Toxicity	3.20	4.5.20	X	X
Abrasion resistance	3.21	4.5.21	X	X

4.5.4 High temperature deformation test. To determine conformance to 3.3, coated vehicle cover material shall be exposed to a temperature of 170°F ± 2°F for a minimum of 6 hours, and then while still maintained at 170°F ± 2°F, shall withstand a 180° bend over a 0.125 inch diameter steel rod with no cracking, delamination, tackiness, or blistering. At least five specimens, 50 millimeters x 150 millimeters, shall be tested in both the warp and fill directions. Samples shall be cut according to the guidelines in ASTM D5035. Specimens shall be rated on a pass/fail basis. A “fail” rating for at least one of the specimens shall be considered a failure of the lot.

4.5.5 Mildew resistance. To determine conformance to 3.4, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM G21.

4.5.6 Odor. To determine conformance to 3.5, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with SAE J1351.

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4.5.7 Flame resistance. To determine conformance to 3.6, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with 49 CFR, Section 571.302.

4.5.8 Glossiness. To determine conformance to 3.8, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D523.

4.5.9 Dimensional stability. To determine conformance to 3.9, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with SAE J883.

4.5.10 Breaking force. To determine conformance to 3.10, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D5035, Test Method 1C-E.

4.5.11 Breaking force after accelerated weathering. To determine conformance to 3.11, coated vehicle cover material shall be exposed to 250 hours of accelerated weathering in accordance with ASTM G26, Test Method 3, followed by 24 hours conditioning at 70°F $\pm$ 2°F and 65 $\pm$ 2 percent relative humidity. After accelerated weathering, the cover material shall then be exposed for two hours at 180°F $\pm$ 5°F, followed by 40 hours at 70°F $\pm$ 2°F and 65 $\pm$ 2 percent relative humidity. The cover material shall then be tested in accordance with ASTM D5035, Test Method 1C-E.

4.5.12 Tearing strength. To determine conformance to 3.12, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D751, Tongue Tear Test Method. The test shall be conducted using a fixed rate of extension of 12 inches per minute, and the tearing strength shall be the average of the five highest peak loads of resistance registered during the separation of the tear.

4.5.13 Waterproofness. To determine conformance to 3.13, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D3393.

4.5.14 Coating adhesion. To determine conformance to 3.14, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D751 at a pulling clamp speed of 5 millimeters per second.

4.5.15 Stiffness. To determine conformance to 3.15, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with TAPPI T451 CM, Preferred Procedure 1. The specimens shall be conditioned at the test temperatures for a minimum of 4 hours before testing. The test shall be conducted in still air.

4.5.16 Blocking resistance at elevated temperature. To determine conformance to 3.16, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D751.

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4.5.17 Resistance to accelerated aging. To determine conformance to 3.17, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested for breaking strength in accordance with FED-STD-191, Method 5852. Additionally, exposed samples shall be evaluated for color change in accordance with AATCC Evaluation Procedure 1 with a minimum rating of 4-5. Stiffness shall be evaluated in accordance with 3.15. No softness or tackiness shall be observed. Brittleness shall be evaluated by the percent elongation at break, which may be obtained from the break strength test procedure. A breaking elongation after aging of less than 10 percent for the warp direction and 20 percent for the fill direction is unacceptable.

4.5.18 Oil resistance. To determine conformance to 3.18, at least 0.5 inch of lubricating oil shall be poured onto an area of approximately one square inch on one side of the coated vehicle cover material and shall be allowed to stand for one hour.

4.5.19 Resistance to aromatic hydrocarbon fluids. To determine conformance to 3.19, coated vehicle cover material shall be immersed in Reference Fuel D conforming to ASTM D471 for 5 minutes and then shall be allowed to dry at room temperature for 2 hours $\pm$ 5 minutes. The sample for immersion shall be at least six inches by six inches in order to minimize edge effects of penetration of the fuel. Evaluation shall be in the center of the sample.

4.5.20 Toxicity. To determine conformance to 3.20, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with 40 CFR, Sections 798.4100, 798.4470, and 798.4500.

4.5.21 Abrasion resistance. To determine conformance to 3.21, coated vehicle cover material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D3389, Method A.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activity within the Military Department or Defense Agency, or within the Military Department's System Command. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature which may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

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6.1 Intended use. The coated vehicle cover material covered by this specification is intended for use on the cab and/or cargo compartment of military combat and tactical vehicles.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of the specification.
b. Issue of DoDISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.2.1 and 2.3).
c. If first article inspection is required (see 3.1).
d. Color of the coated vehicle cloth (see 3.2).
e. Class A or Class B to designate whether infrared reflectance and glossiness requirements apply to both sides or one side only. If unspecified elsewhere in the contract, Class B will apply (see 3.7 and 3.8).
f. Sampling plan required (see 4.4 and 6.3).
g. Packaging requirements (see 5.1).

6.3 Sampling plan. A sampling plan conforming to ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 or to MIL-STD-1916 should be considered when selecting samples from an inspection lot (see 4.4).

6.4 Plain woven materials. Plain woven materials have been specified historically to ensure adequate and uniform seam strength in coated vehicle cover materials. Plain wovens are also among the strongest and most stable forms of fabric weaving. Due to the “lock down” phenomenon of plain wovens, any long-term fabric shifting and skewing is minimized.

6.5 High-tenacity polyester. High-tenacity polyester was tested by TACOM in 1994 and found to be the most cost-effective base material available on the market at that time for the production of durable, long-lasting coated vehicle cover materials.

6.6 Coated cloth weight. Historically, a coated cloth weight of 20 $\pm$ 1 ounce per square yard and a minimum of 23 yarns per inch in both the warp and fill directions have served the U.S. Army well, and is recommended here to ensure long term cover material resilience and durability. (This specification is similar to the Canadian and German Army requirements.) The number of yarns per inch is representative of fabric density and strength, as greater numbers of yarns per inch ensure a larger safety cushion in durability should yarns break during use or contain any manufacturing imperfections. The number of yarns per inch also ensures increased coating adhesion which is very important during heat welding operations.

6.7 PVC coating. Historically, the chemical characteristics of 14 $\pm$ 1.2 ounce per square yard of PVC coating have ensured long term coating durability and limited plasticizer migration and coating cracking.

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6.8 Final vehicle cover assembly. The following information should be considered when a final vehicle cover assembly is constructed.

6.8.1 Grommets. Historically, mechanically-fastened metal grommets have been chosen for load-bearing sections of vehicle cover applications because of their long term durability. As metal grommets are normally mechanically fastened all the way through the vehicle cover, as opposed to plastic grommets, which in the case of heat welding, are fastened to the coating on one side only, metal grommets can better prevent tear-through failures at high-stress, load-bearing sections of the vehicle cover, including cover tie-downs. Metal grommets are also tougher and yield under higher stresses than plastic grommets. Furthermore, plastic grommets are adversely affected in the extreme temperature range the vehicle cover may encounter.

6.8.2 Seam strength. The breaking force of load-bearing seams should be the same as that for the coated cloth.

6.9 Subject term (key word) listing.

Cab
Cargo
Fill
Flame resistance
Mildew
Warp
Weather resistant

6.10 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - AT
Navy - YD1
Air Force - 99

Review Activities:
Air Force - 84
DLA - CS

Preparing Activity:
Army - AT

(Project 25GP-0008)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	**1. DOCUMENT NUMBER** MIL-PRF-32002A	**2. DOCUMENT DATE *(YYMMDD)*** 970905

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
COVER MATERIAL, VEHICLE, COATED TACTICAL AND COMBAT, HEAVY-DUTY, WATERPROOF

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME *(Last, First, Middle Initial)*	**b. ORGANIZATION**	
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)*	**d. TELEPHONE *(Include Area Code)*** **(1) Commercial** **(2) AUTOVON** ***(If applicable)***	**7. DATE SUBMITTED *(YYMMDD)***

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	**b. TELEPHONE *(Include Area Code)*** **(1) Commercial** **(2) AUTOVON** **(810) 574-8745** **786-8745**
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)* **Commander** **U.S. Army Tank-automotive and Armaments Command** **ATTN: AMSTA-TR-E/BLUE** **Warren, MI 48397-5000**	**IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT:** **Defense Quality and Standardization Office** **5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403** **Falls Church, VA 22041-3466** **Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340**

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